



Kinfield Navigator

Family Action Plan for Joan Whitaker

Prepared for Anna Whitaker, daughter

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Plan version	Version 1.0
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This plan contains personal information. Please share it only with people involved in Joan's care.

Your plan at a glance

KEY PRIORITIES

- Now** Make the home safer
- Now** Reduce the risk of another fall
- Soon** Get the right help at home
- Soon** Get a needs assessment
- Soon** Put legal decision-making in place

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- Make the home safer
- Reduce the risk of another fall

20 actions in this plan, 5 to start now.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Fit working smoke alarms (this week)

Your top priorities

- 1 Make the home safer** **Now**
Joan lives alone, so there may be no one nearby if something goes wrong.
- 2 Reduce the risk of another fall** **Now**
Joan has had two falls in the last 12 months.
- 3 Get the right help at home** **Soon**
Joan currently has help from family (3 hours a week).
- 4 Get a needs assessment** **Soon**
Joan has not had a needs assessment yet.
- 5 Put legal decision-making in place** **Soon**
An Enduring Power of Attorney for property is not confirmed.

What you told us

Joan Whitaker, 84, lives alone in a house in Stoke, Nelson.

Joan walks with an aid and has had two falls in the past year.

Health conditions include osteoarthritis and high blood pressure.

Current support: help from family (3 hours a week).

What matters most: stay in her own home and keep going to church.

Notes from the family: Anna visits every Saturday and lives 40 minutes away.

Recommended next steps

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now			
Now	Fit working smoke alarms Install long-life photoelectric alarms in bedrooms, living areas and hallways, and test them.	Family	This week
Now	Arrange a personal alarm Ask the GP whether a funded personal alarm is available, or compare private monitored alarms.	Family with the GP	Within 2 weeks
Now	Walk through the home for hazards Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a GP falls review Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.	Anna Whitaker	Within 2 weeks
Now	Start a strength and balance programme Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.	Joan with family support	Within a month
Soon			
Soon	List the daily tasks that need help Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.	Anna Whitaker	This week
Soon	Compare private home support while waiting If funded help will take time, a few privately paid hours can bridge the gap.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Ask the GP for a NASC referral Request a needs assessment and explain the main concerns in this plan.	Anna Whitaker	This week
Soon	Prepare for the assessment Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.	Family	Before the assessment

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Soon	Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer Book a lawyer and choose attorneys for property and for personal care and welfare.	Joan with family	Within a month
Soon	Find existing legal documents Check with the family lawyer or trustee company whether an EPOA or will already exists, and keep copies.	Anna Whitaker	Within 2 weeks
Soon	Check eligibility for Total Mobility Ask the GP or a local agency about an assessment.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Add rails on both sides of stairs Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.	Family	Within a month
Plan ahead			
Plan ahead	Start an advance care plan Talk with Joan and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.	Joan with the GP	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Find one regular weekly activity A club, class, church group or day programme that Joan would enjoy.	Family	Within 2 months
Plan ahead	Check hearing and eyesight Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.	Joan with family	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Make a one-page emergency sheet List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Plan ahead	Have a family conversation about the future Talk about where Joan would like to live and what matters most.	Joan with family	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Review this plan in six months Update the plan if anything changes sooner.	Family with Kinfield	In 6 months

Your action plan, by topic

Only the topics that apply to Joan are included.

Staying safely at home

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Joan lives alone, so there may be no one nearby if something goes wrong.
- You mentioned: loose rugs in the hallway and poor lighting on the back steps.
- The home may not have working smoke alarms.
- Joan does not have a personal alarm to call for help.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Small changes at home, such as working alarms, good lighting and a way to call for help, prevent many emergencies and make it more likely someone can keep living at home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Fit working smoke alarms** · This week · Family
Install long-life photoelectric alarms in bedrooms, living areas and hallways, and test them.
- ☐ **Arrange a personal alarm** · Within 2 weeks · Family with the GP
Ask the GP whether a funded personal alarm is available, or compare private monitored alarms.
- ☐ **Walk through the home for hazards** · Within a month · Family
Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family and neighbours · GP or practice nurse · Occupational therapist · Fire and Emergency New Zealand

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Would Joan qualify for a funded personal alarm, and how do we arrange it?

Occupational therapist

- Which changes in the home would make the biggest difference to safety?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Smoke alarms [9]

Fire and Emergency New Zealand recommends long-life photoelectric smoke alarms in every bedroom, living area and hallway, and offers home fire safety advice.

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Joan has had two falls in the last 12 months.
- Joan is worried about falling, which can lead to moving less and becoming weaker.
- Joan uses a walking aid.

WHY THIS MATTERS

One fall makes another more likely. Many falls can be prevented with a medication review, strength and balance exercise, and a safer home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a GP falls review** · Within 2 weeks · Anna Whitaker
Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.
- ☐ **Start a strength and balance programme** · Within a month · Joan with family support
Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Physiotherapist · Occupational therapist · Live Stronger for Longer classes

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could any of Joan's medicines be adding to dizziness or falls?
- Should eyesight, blood pressure or bone health be checked after these falls?

Physiotherapist

- Which strength and balance programme suits Joan now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Strength and balance [5]

Live Stronger for Longer lists community strength and balance classes around New Zealand, and GPs can refer people to an in-home programme.

Home care and support

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Joan currently has help from family (3 hours a week).

WHY THIS MATTERS

The right mix of help, from a few hours of household support to daily personal care, is often what makes staying at home possible and safe.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **List the daily tasks that need help** · This week · Anna Whitaker

Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.

- ☐ **Compare private home support while waiting** · Within a month · Family

If funded help will take time, a few privately paid hours can bridge the gap.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Needs Assessment and Service Coordination (NASC) · GP · Home support providers · Pharmacist

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- What funded home support could Joan be eligible for, and how long is the wait?

Pharmacist

- Could medicines be supplied in blister packs, and can the pharmacy review them?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Funded support starts with an assessment ^[1]

Health New Zealand funds home support for eligible older people after a needs assessment by the local NASC service. A GP can make the referral.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Joan's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Tasman Home Support Collective

Matches: Location: Nelson; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Needs assessment

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Joan has not had a needs assessment yet.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most funded support for older people in New Zealand, including home support, carer relief and residential care subsidies, starts with a needs assessment by the local NASC service.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask the GP for a NASC referral** · This week · Anna Whitaker

Request a needs assessment and explain the main concerns in this plan.

- ☐ **Prepare for the assessment** · Before the assessment · Family

Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · NASC service · Hospital social worker

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can you refer Joan for a needs assessment, and how urgent should we say it is?

NASC

- Can family be present at the assessment, and what should we bring?

USEFUL INFORMATION

How assessments work [1]

A NASC assessor visits to understand daily needs, health and support, then coordinates the services the person is eligible for.

EPOA and legal planning

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- An Enduring Power of Attorney for property is not confirmed.
- An Enduring Power of Attorney for personal care and welfare is not in place.
- There is no advance care plan recording Joan's wishes.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An EPOA can only be made while a person can still understand it. Without one, the family may need to apply to the Family Court to make decisions, which takes time and money.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer** · Within a month · Joan with family
Book a lawyer and choose attorneys for property and for personal care and welfare.
- ☐ **Find existing legal documents** · Within 2 weeks · Anna Whitaker
Check with the family lawyer or trustee company whether an EPOA or will already exists, and keep copies.
- ☐ **Start an advance care plan** · Within 3 months · Joan with the GP
Talk with Joan and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Lawyer or trustee company · GP (for capacity questions) · Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Lawyer

- What does Joan need to set up both EPOAs, and how long will it take?

GP

- Is Joan able to make and sign an EPOA now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Two kinds of EPOA [3]

One covers property and money, the other covers personal care and welfare. A welfare EPOA only comes into effect if the person is assessed as no longer able to make decisions.

Making an EPOA [2]

Te Tari Kaumātua publishes the standard forms and explains how they must be witnessed.

Advance care planning [4]

An advance care plan records what matters most to a person about future care, so family and clinicians can follow their wishes.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Joan's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Seniors' Legal Clinic (community law)

Matches: Location: Nelson; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Transport

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Getting to appointments and shops has become difficult.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Losing transport often leads to missed appointments and isolation. Subsidised options can keep someone independent.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Check eligibility for Total Mobility** · Within a month · Family
Ask the GP or a local agency about an assessment.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Total Mobility agencies · Community transport services · GP (for driving fitness)

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Is Joan still safe to drive, and should a driving assessment be done?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Total Mobility [6]

Subsidised taxi and ride-share fares for people who cannot use public transport safely because of an impairment. Eligibility is assessed by an approved agency and subsidies vary by region.

Equipment and home changes

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The home has stairs Joan needs to use.
- Moving around the home safely needs some support.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Rails, shower seats and the right mobility aids are low-cost changes that prevent falls and keep people independent for longer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat** · Within a month · Family
The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.
- ☐ **Add rails on both sides of stairs** · Within a month · Family
Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Occupational therapist · Equipment suppliers · Builder for rails and ramps

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Occupational therapist

- Which equipment is funded, and which would we need to buy?

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Joan's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Able Living Equipment

Matches: Location: Nelson; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Social connection

Plan ahead

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Joan sees people less often than before.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Loneliness affects mood, memory and physical health. One regular activity each week makes a real difference.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Find one regular weekly activity** · Within 2 months · Family
A club, class, church group or day programme that Joan would enjoy.
- ☐ **Check hearing and eyesight** · Within 3 months · Joan with family
Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Age Concern · Local community groups · Church or cultural groups

USEFUL INFORMATION

Visiting services [7]

Age Concern runs visiting and social programmes for older people in many parts of New Zealand.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Joan's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Nelson; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Emergency planning

[Plan ahead](#)

WHAT WE NOTICED

- In an emergency, responders may not know Joan's medicines or who to contact.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A one-page emergency sheet and a backup carer plan save precious time when something unexpected happens.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Make a one-page emergency sheet** · Within 2 weeks · Family
List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Pharmacist

USEFUL INFORMATION

Emergency kits [8]

Get Ready explains how to prepare a household emergency plan, including medicines and mobility needs.

Future planning

Plan ahead

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Joan's goals: stay in her own home and keep going to church.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Talking about wishes before a crisis means future decisions reflect what Joan wants.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Have a family conversation about the future** · Within 3 months · Joan with family
Talk about where Joan would like to live and what matters most.
- ☐ **Review this plan in six months** · In 6 months · Family with Kinfield
Update the plan if anything changes sooner.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Kinfield navigator

Action checklist

Tick actions off as they are done. Your navigator can update the plan with your progress.

Now

- ☐ Fit working smoke alarms · This week
- ☐ Arrange a personal alarm · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Walk through the home for hazards · Within a month
- ☐ Book a GP falls review · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Start a strength and balance programme · Within a month

Soon

- ☐ List the daily tasks that need help · This week
- ☐ Compare private home support while waiting · Within a month
- ☐ Ask the GP for a NASC referral · This week
- ☐ Prepare for the assessment · Before the assessment
- ☐ Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer · Within a month
- ☐ Find existing legal documents · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Check eligibility for Total Mobility · Within a month
- ☐ Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat · Within a month
- ☐ Add rails on both sides of stairs · Within a month

Plan ahead

- ☐ Start an advance care plan · Within 3 months
- ☐ Find one regular weekly activity · Within 2 months
- ☐ Check hearing and eyesight · Within 3 months
- ☐ Make a one-page emergency sheet · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Have a family conversation about the future · Within 3 months
- ☐ Review this plan in six months · In 6 months

We can help you carry this out

Kinfield Navigator can help your family work through this plan: making calls, preparing for assessments and appointments, comparing options and updating the plan as things change.

Phone 0123456789 · **Email** plans@kinfield.example

Sources and important information

1. Ageing support, Healthify. <https://healthify.nz/support/a/ageing-support> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
2. Creating an Enduring Power of Attorney, Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors. <https://www.officeforseniors.govt.nz/our-work/promoting-enduring-power-of-attorney/how-to-create-an-enduring-power-of-attorney> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
3. Understanding when an EPA comes into effect, Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors. <https://www.officeforseniors.govt.nz/our-work/promoting-enduring-power-of-attorney/when-an-epa-comes-into-effect> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
4. Advance care planning, Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. <https://www.myacp.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
5. Live Stronger for Longer, ACC and partners. <https://www.livestronger.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
6. Total Mobility scheme, NZ Transport Agency Waka Kotahi. <https://www.nzta.govt.nz/roads-and-rail/total-mobility-scheme/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
7. Age Concern New Zealand, Age Concern New Zealand. <https://ageconcern.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
8. Get Ready: emergency preparedness, National Emergency Management Agency. <https://getready.govt.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
9. Smoke alarms, Fire and Emergency New Zealand. <https://www.fireandemergency.nz/at-home/smoke-alarms/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)

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This plan gives general information based on what your family told us. It is not medical, legal or financial advice. Eligibility for funding and services is decided by the agencies involved, and details such as thresholds change over time. Please check with the relevant professional before making decisions.